indispensable as before. According to Nanporia, due to the lack of mutual confidence, it was easy for those ‘who believed Sorabji to be insufficiently institutionalized to persuade themselves that he incarnated the “spirit of speculation” and although given a “free hand” he had deliberately kept the Board in the dark.’[6]

Karanjia observes that it was in this strained atmosphere that Masani tried as best as he could to supervise the branches that had been opened to consolidate the bank’s position when its authorized and paid-up capital increased to ₹1 crore and ₹50 lakhs respectively. There was a feeling that the management of the branches left much to be desired, and with a few exceptions they were not sources of real profits. The situation in Karachi was particularly bad and the Manager at Calcutta invited a sharp comment from Sir Dinshaw who in a letter to Masani described the Manager’s concept of a suspense account as ‘a kind of big cauldron in which to throw all sorts of banking accounts to boil and bubble’.[7] The branches were increasingly becoming a drag and Masani did whatever he could to systematize and supervise their working. But in his opinion this hardly justified his salary and he proposed that he go back to London and open an office there for developing the foreign bills business. This had the approval of both Sorabji and Sir Phiroze but before anything could be finalized, Sorabji suddenly decided to go on a six months leave to travel to London.

Sorabji’s sudden departure was the culmination of the seething differences between him and the Board. Sorabji’s remuneration also seems to have attracted attention. There was an opinion in certain quarters that he was being compensated far too generously by way of salary and commissions. The Board decided to stop paying him commission on profits, although a solution was reached by offering him a lump sum of ₹7,000 in lieu of salary and commission on profits. Another source of friction was the summary dismissal by the Board of his brother-in-law who had been appointed as an income-tax expert. According to Nanporia, the brother-in-law was a qualified expert recognized as such by the first Indian Income Tax Commissioner, Jamshedji Vatcha, and the reason for his dismissal was that he had refused to sign the muster roll on the grounds that he was not an ordinary clerk. Sorabji prevented him from suing the Central Bank because he wanted to avoid adverse publicity for something so trivial, and also compensated him from his own pocket.